

Scaling for Peak Demand: From 5 Contracts to ~40 Concurrent Projects

SEC Global · Vice President, HR & Operations · 2013 – 2019 · Multi-state solar construction for major Southeast utility and power-company customers

5 → ~40

CONCURRENT PROJECTS

1,000+

MULTI-STATE CRAFT
WORKFORCE

~25%

FASTER PROJECT TIMELINES

~40%

LOWER ADMIN COST

THE SITUATION

SEC Global delivered solar construction projects for major utility and power-company customers across the Southeast. As new contracts were awarded, the business needed to move from a handful of Florida projects to dozens running at the same time across multiple states. Each new contract meant standing up crews of electricians, laborers, equipment operators and installers, plus the systems, vendors and reporting to support them, often on the customer's timeline rather than ours.

THE CHALLENGE

- Demand arrived in waves as contracts were awarded, not on a steady schedule.
- Every new project needed people, vendors, systems and reporting ready at launch.
- Processes varied by market, which slowed delivery and raised administrative cost.
- Leaders lacked a real-time view of capacity, productivity, staffing and cost.

MY ROLE

- Vice President, HR & Operations for a 1,000+ person, multi-state workforce.
- Owned delivery of newly awarded contracts from post-sale handoff through launch.
- Built and led 4 payroll specialists, 3 HR generalists and 5+ recruiters.
- Co-led the NetSuite to Microsoft Dynamics migration.

WHAT I DID

1

MADE CONTRACT LAUNCH REPEATABLE

Took ownership of every new contract from the post-sale handoff through launch: workforce plan, org structure, systems, reporting, vendors and contractors. Each launch followed the same path, so new projects started faster and with fewer surprises.

2

PLANNED THE WORKFORCE AHEAD OF DEMAND

Directed workforce and capacity planning across the portfolio, matching crews to project commitments and building a recruiting team able to staff new work as contracts landed.

3

STANDARDIZED HOW THE WORK RAN

Replaced market-by-market variation with one set of workflows for staffing, payroll and administration, with clear review standards, documentation and backup coverage.

Scaling for Peak Demand at SEC Global

4

GAVE LEADERS REAL-TIME VISIBILITY

Built real-time reporting on project activity, capacity, productivity, staffing and cost, so leaders could spot risks and shift resources before issues reached customers.

5

MODERNIZED THE SYSTEMS UNDERNEATH

Co-led the NetSuite to Microsoft Dynamics migration from requirements and workflow design through reporting and user adoption, giving the business a platform that could scale with it.

6

BUILT THE TEAM AND KEPT IT COMPLIANT

Built and developed a functional team across payroll, HR and recruiting, and supported multi-state employment compliance as the company entered new markets.

THE LAUNCH PATH EVERY NEW CONTRACT FOLLOWED

01

HANDOFF

Take ownership from sales at award

02

WORKFORCE

Plan crews and recruit to the schedule

03

STRUCTURE

Set the org, owners and systems

04

PARTNERS

Line up vendors and contractors

05

LAUNCH

Go live with reporting in place

RESULTS

- **Growth:** from about 5 Florida contracts to ~40 concurrent projects across the Southeast.
- **Scale:** a 1,000+ person multi-state workforce supported without losing control.

- **Speed:** project timelines cut about 25% through standardized workflows.
- **Cost:** payroll-related administrative cost cut about 40%.

The lesson I took from SEC Global: you can't hire your way through peak demand at the last minute. You win it months earlier, with a repeatable launch process, a workforce plan, standard work and data that shows you what's coming.

HOW THIS TRANSLATES TO LAVINIA GROUP

RISE and summer school peaks

Plan staffing months ahead across full-time, part-time, seasonal and contract educators, with a clear recruit, onboard and deploy path.

Consistency across service lines

Shared standards and workflows for curriculum, coaching, RISE and professional learning operations.

New district partnerships

Treat each new partner like a contract launch: one repeatable path from signed agreement to day-one delivery.

Utilization and finance visibility

Dashboards that connect staffing, utilization, contracts and budget so leaders can act early.